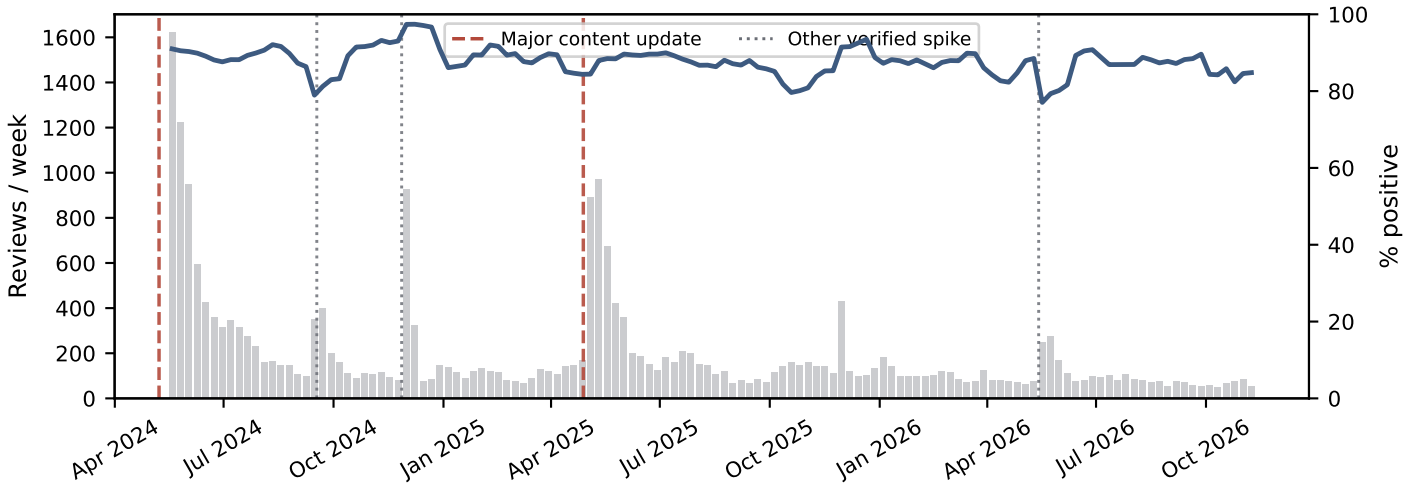
V Rising: Public Steam Review Analysis

English-language Steam reviews, 2024-05-14 to 2026-11-10 • n = 24,835 • 88% positive overall

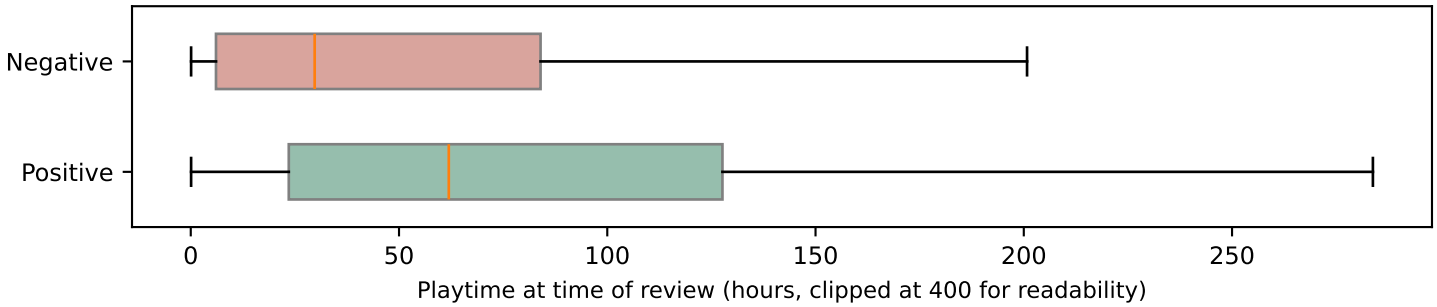
Independent fan analysis using Steam's public review data. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Stunlock Studios.

Review volume and % positive over time



Major updates (red dashed, left to right): 1.0 Launch (8 May 2024), Invaders of Oakveil (28 Apr 2025). Other verified spikes (gray dotted, left to right): 1.0.9.0 patch (17 Sep 2024), Steam Autumn Sale (27 Nov-4 Dec 2024), Free Weekend + 1.1.1 patch (14-18 May 2026). Unlabeled fluctuations elsewhere are not individually explained. Line is a 4-week rolling % positive; weeks below 20 reviews are masked, and the final partial week is excluded.

Playtime at review: positive vs. negative



Findings

1. Positive reviews have a higher median playtime at review (62h) than negative ones (30h): people who bounce off the game tend to say so earlier, not after a long investment.

2. Review volume spikes with each major update and decays back to baseline within roughly 6-8 weeks; % positive (4-week rolling) stays fairly stable through the same window, so volume, not sentiment, is the clearer signal of an update's reach.

3. Negative reviews cluster around six recurring, nameable themes rather than being diffuse (below), not a diagnosis of why but a map of where to look.

Recurring themes in negative reviews

TF-IDF + NMF topic model over negative reviews only. Each line is the model's theme plus one short, clean representative phrase (not a full quote).

1. Boss fights and gear progression feel unbalanced
"For context: I played solo only and defeated all the bosses in normal difficulty."

2. Updates sometimes force a new save to access new content
"Every update, they make it so you cant have your old save get the new content."

3. PvP/PvE server balance and solo-play friction
"This game is just not fun as a PvE player anymore."

4. Combat and the core loop feel slow, repetitive, or grindy
"Boring. Not playing again."

5. Camera and controller control issues
"Horrible camera controls on controller."

6. Solo play feels like more of a grind than with friends
"Not as much fun as it seems."

Limitations

Steam reviewers are a self-selected, vocal subset of players, not a representative sample; this dataset is English-language reviews only; review text reflects stated opinion, not behavioral telemetry (e.g. actual churn points, session structure).

What internal telemetry could add: exact drop-off points, session length and return cadence by patch, and silent churn from players who never write a review at all.